

BONE STORIES - ACTIVITY 2

Facilitator guide

Associate an astragalus with an animal

Guide to learning how to argue a possible association, without requiring expert identification.

TYPE

Facilitator guide

AUDIENCE

Supervising adults

DURATION

45-60 mins

VERSION

Pilot 1.0

Pilot version - corpus of astragali A-D, identification and final correction to be validated.

1. In brief

In groups, the students describe four bones A-D, compare them to possible animals then formulate a reasoned association. In this version, cards A-D are neutral locations: the session trains the method, not the identification of species.

2. Objectives

- Describe a shape without guessing.
- Compare multiple visible clues.
- Formulate a hypothesis with a degree of certainty.
- Name the references needed to verify.

3. Expected success

Successful

Two clues support the association and one uncertainty is named.

In progress

An association is proposed with a single clue.

To resume

The choice rests on the assumed size or chance.

4. Duration and material

Context	Duration	Material
Class	45-60 mins	Sheet, animal cards, A-D cards, pencils.
Museum	30-45 mins	Replicas, educational bones or validated photographs; animal cards.

5. Quick preparation

À PRÉPARER

Cut out the animal cards. Use cards A-D only as templates until the scientific corpus is integrated. Do not prepare a specific response.

À DIRE

“Your job is not to guess. You must defend a hypothesis and say what is missing to verify it. »

6. Detailed procedure

Time	Adult action	Student action	Purpose
5 mins	Present the mission and caution vocabulary.	Read the degrees “possible”, “probable”, “to be verified”.	Lay down the rules of the game.
10 mins	Distribute an A-D card without an animal.	Describe shape, reliefs and surfaces.	Separate observation and attribution.
10 mins	Deal out the animal cards.	Compare locomotion, proportions and organization of the limb.	Build tracks.
15 mins	Request two clues and one limit.	Choose a possible association and argue it.	Explain the reasoning.
10 mins	Put the groups in debate.	Compare the propositions and the missing information.	Understand validation.

7. Questions and reminders

Observe

- What is wide or narrow?
- What surfaces appear articular?
- Which view should be added?

Argue

- Does your clue exclude an animal?
- What other explanation is possible?
- What measurement would help verify?

8. Responses or expected elements

No A-D attribution is expected in this release. The expected productions are verifiable descriptions, an association formulated as a hypothesis, at least two clues and a list of missing information: orientation, scale, species, provenance and comparison to a reference corpus.

9. Differentiation

Need	Adaptation
Help	Reduce to two animals and provide the word bank.
Lighten the writing	Have the argument recorded or dictated.
Go deeper	Have the clues classified from the weakest to the strongest.

10. Museum adaptation

Only use a manipulatable object if museum rules allow it. Otherwise, use an oriented photograph, showcase or replica. Adapt the species to the corpus actually available; never let people believe that a museum necessarily owns the collections mentioned.

11. Quick assessment

Request a sentence comprising four elements: possible association, clue 1, clue 2, information to be verified. Evaluate the quality of the reasoning rather than the name chosen.

12. Common mistakes

À NE PAS AFFIRMER

Do not present the size of the animal as a sufficient criterion. Do not announce cash for empty A-D cards. Do not confuse resemblance and identification.

- Choose your favorite animal.
- Deduce the species from a single curve.
- Forget orientation and scale.
- Use “certain” without reference.

13. Sources and limits

Zeder and Lapham (2010) show the limits of isolated morphological criteria for distinguishing certain postcranial bones of sheep and goats. A reliable attribution requires a reference corpus, an orientation, a scale and zooarchaeological validation. The bat remains an extension, outside the heart of the activity.

14. Current status and remaining validations

À VÉRIFIER

Corpus A-D not integrated. Species, photographs, metadata and final correction must be validated by a person competent in zooarchaeology. The interim scientific media documented in the redesign is explicitly excluded from these PDFs.

Print plan

Each student: student sheet.

Each group: a game of animals and A-D cards.

Adult: guide and method correction.

Cutting: single-sided cards; 120-160 g paper if possible.

Traceability : **Activity page, updates and online credits.**